

Paragraphing

PARAGRAPHS ARE USED TO ORGANIZE A PIECE OF WRITING.

It's important to structure a long piece of writing, such as an essay, article, or letter, into paragraphs. This will break the text up into separate points, which will make it easier to read.

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Starting an introduction with a question will catch the reader's attention.

What's your excuse? Perhaps you don't like getting sweaty, you have no time, or you're just plain lazy. Whatever the reason, you're not alone; fewer and fewer young people are getting enough exercise. However, sports offer numerous health and social benefits, so it's time to stop complaining and get moving.

One way of starting a new paragraph is to indent the first line.

...Thus, regular exercise will not only improve your long-term health, but also make you feel happier and less stressed out.

This paragraph is about the health benefits of exercise.

In addition to the health benefits, playing sports can improve your social life. It is an opportunity to see your friends on a regular basis and to meet new people by joining a team.

A good start

The opening paragraph should state what a piece of writing is about. It also needs to grab the reader's attention so that he or she wants to read on. The first line should be something strong and original, such as a quotation, a rhetorical question, or a statistic.

The great American basketball player Michael Jordan once said, "I can accept failure, but I can't accept not trying."

Start an introduction with a famous or memorable quotation.

Are you putting yourself at risk? People who don't get enough exercise dramatically increase their risk of developing heart disease.

Use a shocking fact to make an impact.

New idea, new paragraph

All the sentences in a paragraph should be related to one another. A new point of discussion requires a new paragraph. Start the new paragraph by indenting the first few words of the text or by skipping a line.

The next sentences are about social benefits, so they start a new paragraph.

Another way to start a new paragraph is to skip a line.

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